

Back to School

Gone are the days when a basic diploma in Web authoring could secure you a job in just about any company that had a dotcom somewhere in its name.

Today you won't find ads from training institutes offering you a life-altering career path. The bubble has burst, shattering with it the illusion that anyone with ground-level knowledge of computers can succeed.

Just having a diploma in computer applications is not enough. Internet companies, like all others, need to be built upon fundamental business principles and employers are looking beyond basic computer literacy to whether you have knowledge about these traditional aspects of business.

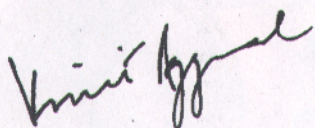
Please wake up and smell the coffee. Computers are only a tool to aid productivity. Talent and tool skills are two different things. Spending thousands of rupees on learning Photoshop and Dreamweaver is not going to take you far if your fundamentals of design are weak or if you lack the ability to visualise.

Companies are cleaning up their act and will not hire anybody and everybody. Recruitment policies have become stricter. No longer can you waltz your way into a company by simply knowing the buzzwords of technology. Experienced and knowledgeable people holding degrees are preferred over inexperienced and 'know-it-all' geeks. Soft skills such as strong communication skills, the ability to learn and adapt in different environments, along with people management experience are imperative.

The only way you can tide over this period of strife is to get back to the basics and rethink on your core competencies. It's wiser to expand upon your inherent skills than to join some training institute to 'learn' computers just because your neighbour and her brother are doing so. Stay in school and acquire traditional qualifications in economics, marketing or engineering. You can then use your computer skills to hone your core areas of expertise.

Similarly, if you're a programmer or software engineer, keep yourself abreast of the latest technology curve. It's not enough to rest on the laurels of your paper qualifications.

Hard work, constant learning and upgrading one's skill-sets and a never-say-die attitude are the way to fame and glory, because these are the only things that remain constant in this unpredictable world of technology.



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